

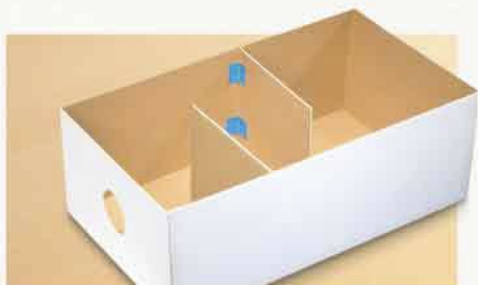
229 Test a plant's senses

45
MINS

Plants don't have eyes, but they know where the Sun is. Their stems move as they grow toward sunlight, which they need to make food. Put a plant in a box and see how it twists and turns.

What you need

- Lidded shoebox • Scissors
- Matte black paint • Tape
- Bean seed • Cardboard
- Flowerpot • Paintbrush
- Potting compost



1 Cut out two cardboard rectangles, each as deep as the box and two-thirds as wide. Tape them to the box. Cut a small hole in one end of the box.



2 Paint the inside of the box black. Plant the bean in the pot, stand it in the box (with the hole at the top), and close the lid.

Shoot
emerges



3 Remove the lid every day to see what's happening. The plant will slowly grow around the flaps until it finds the light.

230 Track a sunflower's movement

5
MINS

Plant a sunflower. Note the position of the flower head during the day as it turns from east to west. Plants that follow the Sun are called heliotropes.



Head
tracks
the Sun

Center
contains
seeds